PRIORITY 20 OF 33 · SCORE 2.9

Justice

DOJ matters more as our customer than as a target: it runs the whistleblower program behind america.gov/fraud, the Health Care Fraud Unit, the Trade Fraud Task Force and the Procurement Collusion Strike Force. Its own fraud risk is in grants (Office of Justice Programs, the Crime Victims Fund passed through states) and in prison contracts. The best DOJ product is a case-mining pipeline that turns its press releases into labeled training data for every other brief.

INVESTIGATIONS WE PROPOSE

DOJ-1	Case library from press releases, the label set for every screen (week 6). **First prototype.**
DOJ-2	OJP, OVW and COPS subgrantee risk.
DOJ-3	Prison commissary, medical and telecom price outliers.

EXPOSURE

- $52B in outlays, mostly salaries, prisons and grants to states and nonprofits.
- Grant risk: subgrantees of victim and public safety grants are many and small, and DOJ OIG regularly finds unsupported costs.
- No DOJ program is listed as high-risk for improper payments.

PUBLIC DATA WE USE

- **DOJ press releases** (all U.S. Attorneys' offices), searchable and structured enough to extract defendants, schemes, programs and dollars.
- **USAspending grants and subawards** for OJP, OVW and COPS.
- **DOJ OIG audit reports** of grantees.
- **FPDS** for Bureau of Prisons and other contracts.

HOW WE DETECT IT

1. **Case mining (for all agencies):** extract defendant names, entities, addresses, schemes and agency from press releases; join to SAM.gov and USAspending to make labeled examples.
2. **Grant subrecipient risk:** subgrantees with prior OIG findings, shared officers across grantees, or award growth without performance data.
3. **Prison contract outliers:** commissary, medical and telecom vendors with prices far above peers.

SCORECARD

Fraud savings identified
● Pending

Phase 1 window
Weeks 2–13
Nov 9, 2026 to Feb 12, 2027

Workstream
Shared screens

FY2026 outlays
$51.7B · budget rank 14

Leads go to
Fraud Section, Civil (FCA), DOJ OIG

WHY PRIORITY 20

Exposure	●●○○○
Public data	●●●○○
SBA method fit	●●●○○
Actionability	●●●●○

FIRST PROTOTYPE

A press-release case database: every fraud case since 2020 tagged by agency and scheme and linked to award records. It becomes the label set for every other prototype.

OUR REVIEW, DELIVERED WEEK 13

Data partner (E) and C3. The case library (F5) is the main DOJ product, finished in week 6 and kept current weekly. In weeks 11-13 run C3 on Office of Justice Programs, OVW and COPS subgrantees and price outliers on Bureau of Prisons commissary, medical and telecom contracts.

Every lead goes to an Inspector General or DOJ as a referral package with sources and caveats. Nothing is published.

WHAT WE ASK OF JUSTICE

Phase 2 data: Subrecipient financial reports, timesheets.

What it enables: Unsupported costs, stipend fraud.

Access route: Each OIG.

LIMITS

Press releases cover charged cases only, which biases labels toward schemes DOJ already finds. Grant subaward reporting is incomplete.

SOURCES

- DOJ Whistleblower Rewards Program terms
- DOJ news releases
- USAspending agency profiles (FY2026 outlays)

Scores and plans are our judgment from public sources. Risk indicators are leads for Inspectors General or DOJ, not accusations.

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